

Benjamin Thompson

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Software Engineer – Front-End Architecture, Component Systems, UI/UX

Front-End Engineer specializing in enterprise web applications, design systems, and accessible component architecture. Known for leading cross-functional delivery of performant, maintainable UI platforms and for building front-end foundations that improve consistency, usability, and development velocity. Brings 20+ years of experience and a focus on AI-assisted development workflows to accelerate modern product teams.

Core Skills

Requirements Assessments | Troubleshooting | Quality Assurance | Risk Identification / Mitigation | Compliance | Analytics | Metrics
Process Improvements | Project / Program Management | Operational Strategy | Influential Decision Making | Stakeholder Engagement
AI-Assisted Development | WCAG Accessibility | UI/UX Design Fundamentals

Technical Skills

Languages: JavaScript | TypeScript | HTML | CSS | Sass/SCSS | JSON | YAML | Groovy | PHP
Front-end Architecture: Angular | React | Svelte | Qwik | SolidJS | Astro | Web Components | RxJS | jQuery
UI & Design: TailwindCSS | Material UI | Angular Material | Shadcn | Bootstrap | Storybook | Figma | *Design systems & Component architecture*
APIs & Back-end: Node.js | Express.js | Dexie | REST | GraphQL | PostgreSQL | MySQL | MongoDB | Supabase | IndexedDB
DevOps: Vite | Webpack | Nx | Docker | AWS | Cloudflare | CI/CD | Jenkins | Git | Jest | Vitest | Testing Library | MSW | *AI-assisted development*

Professional Experience

Lead UI Developer

July 2025 - Apr 2026

LevelBlue, Dallas, TX (remote / contract)

Embedded on a four-person strike team tasked with recovering a cybersecurity product stalled for over a year, with a mandate to ship within six months.

- Architected an opinionated Angular 21 component library that enforced brand, accessibility, and interaction standards by design, making inconsistent UI difficult to produce and accelerating feature delivery.
- Designed the library's API and consumption patterns to support both human developers and AI-driven workflows, ensuring consistent implementation quality across manually authored and AI-generated code.
- Integrated with AI orchestration pipelines governed by ADR guardrails and auditable change logs, aligning the component system with automated workflows and enabling reliable, traceable AI-assisted delivery at scale.

Outcome: Delivered the application within the six-month window, reducing feature delivery timelines from months to weeks while maintaining enterprise-level consistency, accessibility, and auditability.

Senior Software Engineer

Feb 2021 - Jan 2025

Fortra, Eden Prairie, MN (remote)

Transitioned (after Fortra's acquisition of DDI) to a centralized UX engineering role supporting multiple product teams and front-end stacks.

- Built the Angular implementation of Fortra's React-based design system, serving as the sole Angular specialist and enabling adoption of shared UI standards across non-React applications.
- Partnered with UX and engineering teams to implement Figma-driven designs in production, ensuring consistency between design and code across products.
- Acted as lead UI developer on React-based applications, contributing to feature delivery and aligning implementations with shared component and design system standards.
- Supported cross-team development through reusable patterns and component-driven architecture, improving consistency and reducing duplication across the portfolio.

Outcome: Enabled design system adoption across multiple frameworks and teams, supporting consistent UI delivery during post-acquisition integration and product expansion.

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Front-End Engineer (UI and UX)

May 2013 - Feb 2021

Digital Defense, Inc., San Antonio, TX

Joined as one of two front-end engineers to re-architect Frontline VM, a flagship SaaS vulnerability management platform, rebuilding the application from the ground up in AngularJS and delivering it to production.

- Owned UI architecture and UX design for a complex, data-intensive security platform, translating practitioner workflows into an interface optimized for clarity, speed, and usability.
- Built and maintained shared Angular component libraries, establishing reusable patterns that improved consistency and accelerated development across Frontline and related applications.
- Championed and implemented responsive design despite internal resistance, turning adaptability into a differentiator in client demos and field adoption.
- Led modernization of Frontline, migrating the application from AngularJS to Angular 7+ and introducing improved accessibility standards and updated UI patterns.
- Designed and delivered POCs and MVPs using AWS services including Cognito, EC2 and DynamoDB, expanding internal capabilities and supporting new product directions.

Outcome: Delivered and evolved a flagship platform recognized by analysts including Gartner and Frost & Sullivan, and awarded SC Magazine "Best Buy" for usability.

Web Designer and Developer

Nov 2010 - Apr 2013

Independent Freelance Contractor, San Antonio, TX

Delivered full-cycle web design and development for small businesses and nonprofits, from discovery and UX definition through implementation and deployment.

- Built custom WordPress themes and CMS solutions, translating business needs into maintainable front-end systems.
- Led client-facing discovery and communication with non-technical stakeholders, shaping requirements and guiding implementation decisions.
- Engaged as a consultant for the University of Colorado Book Store, conducting a full site audit and subsequently delivering the recommended redesign and improvements.

Outcome: Shipped end-to-end web and CMS solutions for organizations including the University of Colorado Book Store and other independent clients.

Lead UI and Graphic Designer

Feb 2006 - Apr 2010

MOD Systems, Seattle, WA

Sole designer for an early media-on-demand platform delivering digital content through retail kiosks, mobile devices, and set-top boxes prior to mainstream streaming.

- Designed the end-to-end user experience across kiosk, mobile, and TV platforms, including systems deployed nationally with partners such as **Starbucks HEAR Music, Best Buy, Blockbuster, and Circuit City**.
- Translated complex media workflows into intuitive retail and consumer experiences, and produced product concepts and investor materials that helped secure digital rights from major studios and networks.
- Directed contract designers and owned all brand, marketing, and exploratory product work, including early mobile-first digital commerce concepts.

Education

Associate of Science, Digital Media

Full Sail University, Winter Park, FL

2004 - 2005

- Class Valedictorian
- Advanced Achiever Award
- Certificate of Excellence

Military Experience

Boatswain's Mate 3rd Class

2008 - 2016

US Coast Guard Reserve, Everett, WA | Port O'Connor, TX